

USER GUIDE

AI-Powered Travel Planning Assistant

Travito

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1. What is Travito?

Travito is a full-stack web application that uses the Groq AI engine (Llama-3.3-70b) to plan your travel itineraries, recommend hotels, build packing checklists, track your trip expenses, and answer destination-specific questions through an interactive AI chatbot.

It runs completely locally on your machine — no cloud hosting or server setup needed.

Feature	Description
AI Itinerary Generation	Day-by-day travel plans powered by Llama-3.3-70b
Hotel Recommendations	Budget, mid-range, and luxury options tailored to you
Packing Checklist	Categorized lists: Documents, Clothing, Electronics, and more
Expense Tracker	Real-time budget gauge and spending records
AI Travel Chatbot	Ask destination-specific questions anytime

2. Project File Structure

Below is an overview of every file and folder in the Travito project:

Path	Purpose
index.html	Web app entry point (HTML)
vite.config.js	Frontend build configuration
package.json	Root (frontend) dependencies list
src/main.jsx	React app bootstrap file
src/index.css	All styles (glassmorphic theme)
src/App.jsx	Main application component (all views)
src/context/AuthContext.jsx	User login state management
backend/server.js	Main Express server entry point
backend/package.json	Backend dependencies list
backend/.env	API keys — NEVER share this file
backend/routes/auth.js	Login / Register API endpoints
backend/routes/trips.js	Trip CRUD API endpoints
backend/routes/expenses.js	Expense tracker API endpoints
backend/routes/ai.js	Groq AI integration & mock fallback
database/schema.sql	Table definitions (auto-run on startup)
database/db.js	Database connection helper
database/travel_planner.db	Auto-created SQLite database on first run
docs/	Academic documentation folder
report/FINAL_REPORT.md	Final academic project report
testing/TEST_CASES.md	QA test matrix and bug report
screenshots/	UI screenshots for documentation

3. Setup Guide — Windows (Recommended)

Step 1: Install Node.js

1. Open your browser and go to: <https://nodejs.org/en/download>
2. Download the Windows Installer (.msi) for LTS (Long Term Support) version.
3. Run the downloaded .msi installer.
4. Click: Next → Accept License → Next → Install → Finish
5. During setup, if asked to install Chocolatey or additional tools, check that box too.

Verify Node.js is installed:

6. Press Windows Key + R, type cmd, press Enter.
7. In the terminal window, type:

```
node --version
```

You should see something like v20.x.x. If you do, Node.js is ready.

Step 2: Open the Project Folder in Terminal

8. Extract the ZIP file to a location on your computer, e.g.
C:\Users\YourName\Desktop\Travito
9. Open File Explorer and navigate inside the Travito folder.
10. Click the address bar, type cmd, and press Enter. (Opens Command Prompt directly in the project folder)

Step 3: Install Root (Frontend) Dependencies

In the Command Prompt window, type:

```
npm install
```

Wait for it to finish. You will see a message like added 165 packages.

Step 4: Install Backend Dependencies

```
npm install --prefix backend
```

Wait for it to finish. You will see added 170 packages.

Step 5: Configure Your API Key (Optional)

Open the file backend\.env in Notepad (right-click → Open with → Notepad). You will see:

```
PORT=5001
JWT_SECRET=super_secret_travel_key_123
GROQ_API_KEY=YOUR_GROQ_API_KEY
```

Replace YOUR_GROQ_API_KEY with your actual key from <https://console.groq.com>

Step 6: Start the Backend Server

```
node backend\server.js
```

You should see:

```
Database initialized successfully.
No Groq API Key found. Backend running in MOCK mode.
Server is running on port 5001
```

Keep this window open. Do not close it.

Step 7: Open a Second Terminal for the Frontend

11. Open File Explorer again inside the Travito folder.
12. Click the address bar, type cmd, press Enter (opens another Command Prompt).
13. In this new window, type:

```
npm run dev
```

You should see:

```
VITE v5.x.x ready in 2000ms
Local: http://localhost:3000/
```

Step 8: Open Travito in Your Browser

Open any browser (Chrome recommended) and go to:

```
http://localhost:3000
```

Travito will load successfully.

4. Setup Guide — macOS

Step 1: Install Node.js

Open Terminal (press Cmd + Space, type Terminal, press Enter).

Install via Homebrew (easiest method):

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"  
brew install node
```

Or download the macOS installer from <https://nodejs.org/en/download>

Verify:

```
node --version
```

Steps 2–8: Same as Windows

Follow the same steps as the Windows guide above, using Terminal instead of Command Prompt.

Windows	macOS Equivalent
Command Prompt (cmd)	Terminal
node backend\server.js	node backend/server.js
Backslash (\) in paths	Forward slash (/) in paths
File Explorer	Finder

5. Configuring Your Groq API Key

Scenario	What Happens
Key is YOUR_GROQ_API_KEY (unchanged)	Mock Mode — realistic fallback data shown
Key is blank	Mock Mode — realistic fallback data shown
Valid Groq key is provided	Real Llama-3.3-70b AI generation activated

How to Get a Free Groq API Key

14. Go to <https://console.groq.com>
15. Create a free account.
16. Click API Keys → Create API Key.
17. Copy the key and paste it in backend/.env replacing YOUR_GROQ_API_KEY.

6. Running the Application

You need two terminal windows open at the same time:

Terminal Window	Command	What It Does
Terminal 1	node backend\server.js	Runs the API server on port 5001
Terminal 2	npm run dev	Runs the React frontend on port 3000

Then open <http://localhost:3000> in your browser.

7. How to Use Travito

7.1 Creating an Account

18. On the login page, click Create an Account.
19. Enter your Full Name, Email, and Password (minimum 6 characters recommended).
20. Click Create Account — you will be logged in automatically.

7.2 Planning a Trip

21. Click Plan New Trip in the left sidebar.
22. Fill in the form:
 - Destination: Type any city or country name (e.g. Tokyo, Japan)
 - Start Date: Must be today or in the future
 - End Date: Must be after start date (max 30-day trips)
 - Budget Cap: Minimum \$50
 - Companion: Solo, Couple, Family, or Friends
 - Travel Style: Culture, Adventure, Relaxation, or Foodie
23. Click Generate AI Draft — wait 2 to 5 seconds.
24. Review the generated day-by-day itinerary, hotels, and packing list.
25. Click Save Trip to store it permanently.

7.3 Viewing Trip Details

On the dashboard, click any trip card. Navigate using the tabs at the top:

Tab	What You See
Itinerary	Day-by-day activity schedule
Hotels	AI-suggested accommodations by budget tier
Packing List	Checkboxes organized by category (Documents, Clothing, etc.)
Expenses & Budget	Track spending with a visual circular gauge
AI Travel Guide	Interactive AI chatbot for destination questions

7.4 Tracking Expenses

26. Go to the Expenses & Budget tab inside a trip.
27. Enter Description, Amount (USD), Category, and Date.
28. Click Add Expense.
29. The circular gauge updates in real-time.

7.5 Using the AI Chatbot

Click the AI Travel Guide tab. Ask anything, for example:

- "Is tap water safe to drink in Thailand?"
- "Should I tip at restaurants in Japan?"
- "What documents do I need for Dubai?"

8. Edge Cases & Validation Rules

Travito enforces strict input rules to prevent invalid data:

Scenario	Result
Start date is in the past	Error: Start date cannot be in the past
End date is before start date	Error: End date must be after the start date
Trip longer than 30 days	Error: Please limit trips to 30 days maximum
Destination is just numbers (e.g. 12345)	Error: Destination cannot be purely numbers or symbols
Destination is only 1 character	Error: At least 2 characters required
Budget below \$50	Error: Minimum trip budget is \$50
Budget above \$1,000,000	Error: Budget seems too high
Expense amount is 0 or negative	Error: Please enter a valid positive amount
Expense amount over \$100,000	Error: Amount seems unusually high
Expense description is blank	Error: Please enter a brief description
AI returns empty/malformed data	Falls back to mock itinerary automatically
Groq API is down or key is invalid	Falls back to mock itinerary automatically

9. What to Exclude When Zipping (Sharing)

When sharing the project as a .zip, exclude these folders and files to reduce file size:

Do NOT Include

Path	Reason
node_modules/	Root frontend dependencies (~80MB) — auto-regenerated via npm install
backend/node_modules/	Backend dependencies (~50MB) — auto-regenerated via npm install
database/travel_planner.db	Contains personal user data including hashed passwords
backend/.env	Contains secret API key — NEVER share this file

CAUTION: Never include backend/.env in a file you share publicly or email to others. It may contain your secret Groq API key.

Do Include

- src/
- backend/ (but NOT backend/node_modules or backend/.env)
- database/schema.sql
- database/db.js
- docs/
- report/
- testing/
- screenshots/
- index.html | package.json | package-lock.json | vite.config.js

How to Create the Zip on Windows

Option 1 — File Explorer:

30. Open the Travito folder.
31. Select all files except node_modules, backend/node_modules, database/travel_planner.db, and backend/.env
32. Right-click → Compress to ZIP file (Windows 11) or Send To → Compressed folder (Windows 10).

Option 2 — Command Prompt (handles exclusions automatically):

```
powershell Compress-Archive -Path src,backend\server.js,backend\package.json,
backend\routes,database\schema.sql,database\db.js,docs,report,testing,
screenshots,index.html,package.json,vite.config.js -DestinationPath Travito.zip
```

What the Recipient Needs to Do

After unzipping, they run:

```
npm install
npm install --prefix backend
node backend/server.js (Terminal 1)
npm run dev (Terminal 2)
```

Then open <http://localhost:3000> in a browser.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
node: command not found	Node.js is not installed. Go to Step 1 of the Setup Guide.
Cannot find module 'better-sqlite3'	Run npm install in the root project folder again.
Error: listen EADDRINUSE :::5001	Port 5001 is in use. Close other apps or change PORT in backend/.env to 5002.
Error: listen EADDRINUSE :::3000	Vite port is taken. Edit vite.config.js and change port: 3000 to port: 3001.
White screen in browser	Wait 3 to 5 seconds and refresh. Vite may still be compiling.
Itinerary fails to generate	Check that both servers are running. The backend (Terminal 1) must run before the frontend.
Database file not created	Check that the database/ folder exists. Run node backend/server.js to create the .db file.

Document Information

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